

Question 13 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Analyse how a weak HRD climate can affect employee behaviour and organisational performance.

Introduction

Analyse means show cause → mechanism → effect. Weak HRD climate means low trust, closed communication, little support for learning, unfair development chances, and fear. Such climate changes how people behave; behaviour then damages performance. This is not a 'soft' topic; it is a performance analysis.

Detailed points

- 1. Fear, silence and hiding mistakes.** When people expect punishment, they hide errors and stop asking questions. Problems grow until they explode (customer crisis, accident). Organisational performance suffers through late discovery of issues.
- 2. Low initiative and learned helplessness.** Without autonomy and support, employees wait for orders. Proactivity — a feature of enabling culture — dies. The organisation becomes slow and over-dependent on a few bosses. In a changing market this is fatal.
- 3. Training without transfer.** Even expensive programmes fail because the workplace does not allow new methods. People return from training and are told 'forget that, do it the old way'. Behaviour does not change; training budget is wasted; performance stays flat.
- 4. Defensive and political appraisal behaviour.** In a weak climate, ratings become weapons. Employees manage impressions, not work. Honest feedback is absent, so individuals cannot improve. Average organisational performance is mis-measured and mis-managed.
- 5. Broken collaboration.** Units protect their boundaries, blame others, and refuse to share knowledge. Team performance and decision quality fall. Customers see delays and contradictions.
- 6. Demotivation, withdrawal and turnover.** Higher-order needs are blocked. People do the minimum, stay absent, or leave. Those who stay may be the less marketable. Human capital quality declines, dragging performance down.
- 7. Unused potential.** Capabilities are neither identified nor used. The firm pays for unused talent. Growth plans fail because internally nobody is ready — a direct performance constraint.
- 8. Combined performance effect.** Put together: more errors, less innovation, weak service, high cost of attrition, poor strategy implementation. Weak HRD climate is therefore a structural cause of organisational under-performance, not merely 'low morale' as a feeling.

Conclusion. Structure the analysis: weak climate → fear/silence, no initiative, no transfer, politics, silos, exit → lower quality, speed, innovation and human capital. End with: fix climate or other HRD tools will fail.